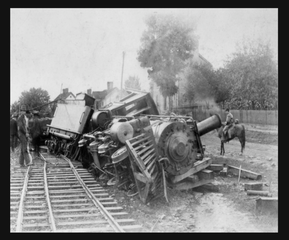
MANAGERIAL BEHAVIOR ASSOCIATED WITH MANAGERIAL DERAILMENT IN THE U.S. AND SEVERAL ASIAN COUNTRIES



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TRiO
RONALD E. McNAIR POST-BACCALAUREATE ACHIEVEMENT PROGRAM

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Business organizations face changing market conditions that can potentially be overwhelming for managers. This can lead to managerial derailment, and the cost to the individual and organization are very high. Organizations attempt to address this through management development initiatives, often including developmental tools such as a multi-rater feedback instrument. Although it is very important to identify successful managers, it is also as important for organizations and managers to be aware of the behaviors that are associated with managerial derailment. This study is based on the analysis of behaviors that are associated with high risk of managerial derailment, using a multi-rater instrument.

BACKGROUND

Managerial derailment occurs when an individual identified as high potential and expected to advance in their organization fails to do so (Lombardo & McCauley, 1988). Previous studies in managerial derailment had identified five general clusters of managerial behavior that were associated with managerial derailment:

- Problems with interpersonal relationships
- Difficulty leading a team
- Difficulty changing or adapting
- Failure to meet business objectives
- Too narrow function orientation

Multi-rater feedback instruments provide feedback from boss, peers, and direct report for developing participants.

PURPOSE OF RESEARCH

To inform ongoing HRD and management development practice in a useful way by better understanding the specific behaviors displayed by individuals in managerial leadership roles in mid- to large-size private sector business organizations that are associated with predictions of high risk of managerial derailment in the United States and several Asian countries. The research question is:

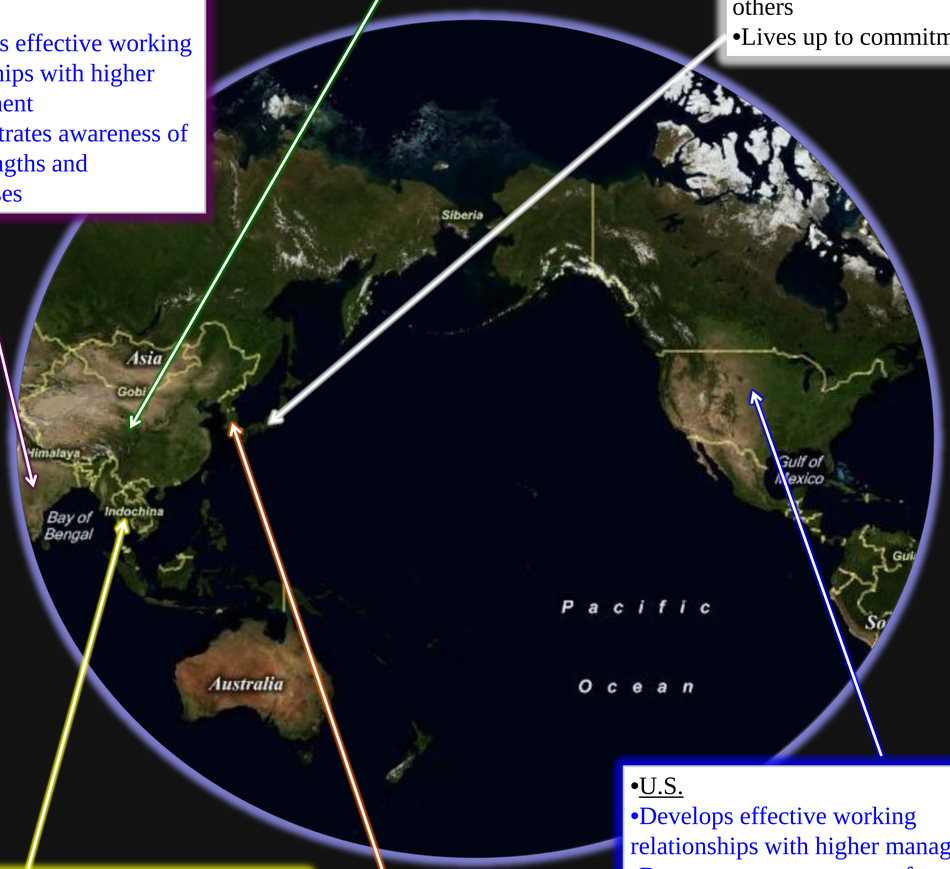
What are the managerial behaviors, as described by the manager's boss, that are associated with predictions by the same boss of a high risk of derailment among managers in the United States and several Asian countries?

RESULTS

China
- Develops effective working relationships with higher management
- Demonstrates awareness of own strengths and weaknesses
- Knows which battles are worth fighting
- Treats people with respect
- Provides clear direction and defines priorities for the team
- Fosters the development of a common vision

Japan
- Develops effective working relationships with higher management
- Has the confidence and trust of others
- Accurately identifies strengths and development needs in others
- Lives up to commitments

India
- Develops effective working relationships with higher management
- Demonstrates awareness of own strengths and weaknesses



Thailand
- Develops effective working relationships with higher management
- Speaks effectively in front of a group

South Korea
- Demonstrates awareness of own strengths and weaknesses
- Shows consistency between words and actions

U.S.
- Develops effective working relationships with higher management
- Demonstrates awareness of own strengths and weaknesses
- Creates an environment where people work their best
- Expresses disagreement tactfully and sensitively
- Develops effective working relationships with peers
- Has the confidence and trust of others

INSTRUMENT

The behavioral data gathered for this study were taken from The PROFILOR®, a multi-rater feedback questionnaire, developed by PDI Ninth House, that collects responses from supervisors, peers, and direct reports of participants in leadership and management development programs.

Sample Size

U.S.	China	Japan
14,236	399	1,495
$R^2 = 0.476$	$R^2 = 0.537$	$R^2 = 0.380$

South Korea	India	Thailand
131	285	80
$R^2 = 0.289$	$R^2 = 0.186$	$R^2 = 0.711$

METHOD

There was a three-step process:

First a stepwise logistic regression was applied separately to the U.S. and the six Asian countries combined, choosing the 'best' non-spurious predictors for the U.S. and for Asia.

Second, stepwise logistic regression, however unstable, was run on the six Asian countries individually. Again, the best predictors were kept, that did not overlap with the first group.

Finally, stepwise regressions were run in blocks, allowing first, the selection from the overall model (U.S. and Asia), and secondly allowing the selection from any of the behaviors unique to one or more Asian countries. It should be noted that many of these behaviors act as proxies for each other. We were looking for a model both highly predictive and parsimonious. This technique reduced the set of possible independent variables from 135 behaviors to blocks of 11 and 7 behaviors.

DISCUSSION

The purpose of this study was to create a parsimonious set of PROFILOR® behaviors, for managers in the U.S. and five Asian countries, that are associated with the supervisor's prediction of the potential of their employee's career derailment. The large Nagelkurke Pseudo-R^{2*} measured in each of the countries suggest that these few items are useful, practical predictors of managerial derailment.